

Sweden

Ratio: 5:8 **Adopted:** June 22, 1906 **Usage:** National and Civil

The yellow and blue colors are taken from the national arms



The distinctive Scandinavian cross is taken from the flag of Denmark

Europe



Until 1523, when King Gustav Vasa laid the foundation of **Sweden** as a separate state, the country was under the influence of Denmark.

The present flag was adopted in 1906, but it was first used in a similar form almost four centuries before. The design is based on the Scandinavian cross. The flag's blue and yellow colors are thought to come from the national coat of arms—three gold crowns in a blue field—which originated in the 14th century. A national flag day is celebrated each year on June 6.

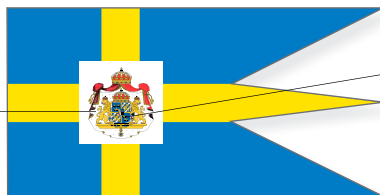
On this day in 1523 King Gustav Vasa was elected and, on the same date in 1809, Sweden adopted a new constitution.

SWEDISH ROYAL STANDARD

The coat of arms is placed in the center of the Royal Standard, which is used on special occasions by Parliament and dates from the 1440s.

THE ROYAL STANDARD

The shield is supported by two golden lions



The triple crown symbolizes the "Three Wise Men," a Swedish emblem since 1336